

1. On the

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-05-23T20:24:48+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/May/23/on-the-dl/#atom-everything>

On the I learned a few new-to-me things about the element from this article by Ben Meyer: A can be followed by multiple You can optionally group the and elements in a for styling - but only a . You can label them using ARIA. They've been called "description lists", not "definition lists", since an HTML5 draft in 2008 . So this is valid: `h2 id="credits">Credits</h2><dl aria-labelledby="credits"><dt>Author</dt><dd>Jeffrey Zeldman</dd><dd>Ethan Marcotte</dd></dl>` Here's a useful note from Adrian Roselli on screen reader support for description lists . Via Hacker News Tags: `css` , `html` , `screen-readers` , `web-standards`

2. datasette-agent-charts 0.1a1

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-05-20T14:52:16+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/May/20/datasette-agent-charts/#atom-everything>

Release: datasette-agent-charts 0.1a1 More color! Bar and waffle charts without a color column are shaded by magnitude with a sequential color scheme; color columns holding text values use the observable10 categorical scheme. #2 Now checks execute-sql permission before running the query to find the column names. Charts now display interactive tooltips. Fixed a bug where waffleY charts were not described to the agent. Tags: `datasette` , `datasette-agent`

3. llm-gemini 0.32a0

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-05-19T20:36:23+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/May/19/llm-gemini/#atom-everything>

Release: llm-gemini 0.32a0 Compatible with llm>=0.32a0 alpha - adds the ability to stream reasoning tokens. Tags: `llm` , `gemini`

4. Stephen Colbert's 'The Late Show' Finale

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-22T17:12:10Z

Link: https://www.nytimes.com/2026/05/22/arts/television/colbert-last-late-show.html?unlocked_article_code=1.kVA.G03l.gVq9KeUrHEyM

James Poniewozik, writing for The New York Times (gift link): He didn't land the pope, but he got a Beatle. He didn't have a new project to announce, but he left us with a song (in fact two). He didn't choose to end his show, but he ended it his own weird, wonderful way. Stephen Colbert hosted his final 'Late Show' on Thursday night, completing the story of the TV year's most notorious and rancorous cancellation. But his final hour-plus - an emotional and delightfully bizarre wake for a comedy institution - turned it into a cancellebration. [...] In fact, the episode gradually revealed a story arc, more like the closing episode of a surreal comedy than of a talk show. Series finales are so difficult to do well. I find them compelling even when they fall a little flat. Colbert's finale last night was just amazingly good. Good and fun and surprising and perfectly on-brand. And what a song to end on. Perfect. ?

5. Google I/O Keynote in 54 Seconds

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-21T15:31:54Z

Link: <https://x.com/ArtemR/status/2056961743142957143>

Tight edit but covers the whole thing. (XCancel link ; Threads link .) ?

6. 'Geography Is Four-Dimensional'

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-21T14:39:19Z

Link: <https://sive.rs/4d>

Derek Sivers: When someone speaks of a place, you have to ask, 'When?? Geography is four-dimensional. You can't know a place - only a place as it was at a time. Where is bound to when. Unless you are in a place right now, you can only speak of it in past-tense. ?

7. Hilbert transform as an infinite matrix

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Sat, 23 May 2026 15:09:34 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/05/23/hilbert-transform-as-an-infinite-matrix/>

The previous post linked to a post I wrote a few years ago about the Hilbert transform and Fourier series. That post says that if the Fourier series of a function is then the Fourier series of its Hilbert transform is When I looked back at that post I thought about how if you thought [?] The post Hilbert transform as an infinite matrix first appeared on John D. Cook .

8. Real and imaginary parts

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Sat, 23 May 2026 13:57:21 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/05/23/real-and-imaginary-parts/>

The previous post announced some notes I wrote up based on an article by Henry Baker implementing functions of a complex variable in terms of functions of a real variable. That is, it finds functions $u(x, y)$ and $v(x, y)$ such that $f(x + iy) = u(x, y) + i v(x, y)$ where x, y, u , and v are [?] The post Real and imaginary parts first appeared on John D. Cook .

9. Building complex functions out of real parts

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Sat, 23 May 2026 03:24:10 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/05/22/complex-functions-real-parts/>

A couple months ago I wrote about how to compute the sine and cosine of a complex number using only real functions of real variables using the equations You can do something analogous for all the elementary functions, though some of the equations are quite a bit more complicated than the ones above. See the [?] The post Building complex functions out of real parts first appeared on John D. Cook .

10. Reverse engineering circuitry in a Spacelab computer from 1980

Source: Ken Shirriff's blog | Published: 2026-05-23T09:17:44.885-07:00

Link: <http://www.righto.com/2026/05/reverse-engineering-spacelab-computer.html>

Spacelab was a reusable laboratory that could be carried in the cargo bay of the Space Shuttle, providing lab space for astronauts and experiments. Spacelab was controlled by a French-built minicomputer, called the Mitra 125 MS . Unlike modern computers, this computer didn't contain a microprocessor chip. Instead, its 16-bit processor was constructed from several boards of chips. In this article, I reverse-engineer one of the processor boards, shown below, part of the computer's Arithmetic/Logic Unit (ALU). The Mitra 125 MS computer, built by CIMSA, with one of the ALU/register cards shown. Spacelab consisted of a pressurized cylindrical laboratory that held experiments, computers, and work areas for researchers. A tunnel connected the laboratory to the Shuttle, allowing researchers to move between the Shuttle and Spacelab. Spacelab also supported up to five unpressurized "pallets" that were exposed to space, holding experiments such as telescopes and sensors. The illustration below shows the tunnel, the Spacelab laboratory, and a pallet installed in the Shuttle's cargo bay. 1 Illustration of the Spacelab-3 mission. From NASA . Because Spacelab was a European project, it used a Eu...

11. How our environment still needs the security boundary of Unix logins

Source: Chris's Wiki :: blog | Published: 2026-05-23T23:30:39Z

Link: <https://utcc.utoronto.ca/~cks/space/blog/sysadmin/WhyWeNeedUnixLoginSecurity>

In a comment on this recent entry , I was asked if we still considered Unix logins to be a serious security boundary. This is a sensible question; there are a horde of Linux local privilege escalation vulnerabilities going around right now (and one FreeBSD one for spice), and in general (some) security people have been saying for years that once an attacker had local code execution, the game was over. Our answer is that yes, we consider it a serious security boundary, and if that situation ever changed we'd need a drastically different system environment from our current environment . Our current environment has shared NFS filesystems where people keep all their files and data , shared login servers for both general usage and compute, a (shared) SLURM computer cluster , and a reasonably flexible shared web server

environment where people can run programs . While some people are still using our login servers interactively, others are running software (such as VSCode) that connects to them somewhat behind the scenes and uses them to run tools. All of this is critically dependent on the security provided by Unix logins; if Unix logins weren't a real security boundary any more, anyone...

12. My views on Flymake and Flycheck in GNU Emacs (as of mid 2026)

Source: Chris's Wiki :: blog | Published: 2026-05-23T02:58:54Z

Link: <https://utcc.utoronto.ca/~cks/space/blog/programming/EmacsFlymakeFlycheck>

One of the divisions in GNU Emacs people is between using Flymake , which is built into GNU Emacs and is well supported by other standard GNU Emacs packages such as Eglot , and using Flycheck . I've used Flycheck for a long time (cf) and recently tried using Flymake , which has given me some pragmatic opinions for my own usage. (For non GNU Emacs people, Flymake and Flycheck both exist to present (and to some extent detect) 'diagnostics' about your code or whatever file you're editing.) For me, Flymake and Flycheck are about as good as each other, at least in LSP based environments and Emacs Lisp. Flymake is better integrated into Eglot and can make errors more visible, Flycheck comes with more keybindings by default, and I go back and forth about how I feel about their modelines (after I diminished Flymake's verbose modeline name down to 'FlyM' and changed the colours a bit). Why I prefer Flycheck is that it's more flexible in one way that matters to me. My particular taste with checkers is that by default I only want to see actual errors (or relatively strong style issues), but I want to have access to linters that express views I may not agree with in order to see what they s...

13. Which age-gates should be skill-gates and vice-versa?

Source: Terence Eden?s Blog | Published: Sat, 23 May 2026 11:34:31 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/05/which-age-gates-should-be-skill-gates-and-vice-versa/>

In the UK, it is illegal to buy alcohol if you are under 18. Similarly, in most countries, you cannot vote until you have reached a specific age. These are age-gates. You do not need to prove your competence to drink, vote, smoke, or get married; you just need to be old enough. Some things have skill-gates. If you want an amateur radio licence in the UK, you need to pass an exam. You can be?

14. This Week in Package Management: 23 May 2026

Source: Andrew Nesbitt | Published: 2026-05-23T10:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://nesbitt.io/2026/05/23/this-week-in-package-management.html>

I'm trying out a weekly roundup built from the package manager OPML feed collection and whatever I've posted or boosted on Mastodon . npm is removing npm-shrinkwrap.json entirely in the v12 prereleases. The command, the config alias, and the loader all gone; project-root shrinkwraps need renaming to package-lock.json and shipping a locked tree inside a tarball now means bundleDependencies . Security uv 0.11.15 fixes two issues worth patching for: a TAR parser differential and entry points escaping the scripts directory . 0.11.16 followed with uv audit now refusing locked installs that match known-malware records. Ruby 4.0.5 shipped with a fix for CVE-2026-46727; anyone on 4.0.0 through 4.0.4 should update. GitHub confirmed that around 4,000 of its own internal repositories were exfiltrated this week. The Register reports the entry point was a poisoned VS Code extension and attributes it to TeamPCP, the group behind the Shai-Hulud worm. The Nx team published a postmortem of the Nx Console v18.95.0 compromise , another poisoned VS Code extension. The detail that stands out: the affected contributor had minimum-release-age set in .npmrc , but their pnpm was old enough to silently ign...

15. Reading List 05/23/26

Source: Construction Physics | Published: Sat, 23 May 2026 12:02:39 GMT

Link: <https://www.construction-physics.com/p/reading-list-052326>

Squatter removal services, Apple finding uses for defective chips, process heat use in California, the brewing Colorado River crisis, and more.

16. There is only one bad AI scenario

Source: the singularity is nearer | Published: 2026-05-23T00:00:00-07:00

Link: <https://geohot.github.io//blog/jekyll/update/2026/05/23/one-bad-scenario.html>

I've pushed AI doomers on how exactly the AI kills us, and I've never heard a good answer. I think Skynet style scenarios where humanity is largely opposed to an out of control AI are science fiction domination fantasies, along with Gray goo bottom-up scenarios. Both of these assume a major continuity break with current reality, too bizarre to be true. But unfortunately, you don't need this for humanity to end as an open-ended evolutionary process. I think the danger is that AI continues to optimize the current societal loss function of domestication. Humans have endured terrible systems, but fundamentally, humans are evolutionary creatures. Any system of totalitarian control must be able to reproduce generationally. It cannot merely dominate adults; it has to produce children who can live inside it, maintain it, and continue it. And because of how humans reproduce, there's always evolutionary randomness. Entropy locally asserts itself, and reality cannot be perfectly controlled. I'm not sure it's possible, but if there is a bad scenario with AI, it's a singleton with nothing that can substantially impact reality outside of it. And this won't happen through Hitlerian language, it...

17. Don't Roll Your Own ...

Source: Susam Pal | Published: 2026-05-23T00:00:00Z

Link: <https://susam.net/do-not-roll-your-own.html>

This is going to be a rant about modern web design practices. But before I get to that, let me begin with a familiar principle from the world of cryptography. Among software developers, and especially among those who work on security-sensitive systems, there is a well-known maxim: Don't roll your own crypto. This does not mean that nobody is allowed to write cryptographic code. Someone has to. It means that, for ordinary production software that protects sensitive data of users, we should not rely on a private, unreviewed implementation that has not been vetted by the wider software development community. We should use established, vetted software packages or tools wherever possible. Fortunately, it is now standard industry practice to avoid rolling your own crypto and instead use cryptographic algorithms and packages that have been peer reviewed and stood the test of time. It wasn't so some twenty years ago. I have seen several flawed home-grown RC4 implementations early in my career, with issues like improper initialisation vectors, predictable keystreams and partial leakage of plaintext into ciphertext, putting sensitive data of users at risk. But today, major e-commerce websites...

18. Weekly Update 505

Source: Troy Hunt | Published: Sun, 24 May 2026 01:34:54 GMT

Link: <https://www.troyhunt.com/weekly-update-505/>

Well, that didn't last long! Recording this on Saturday morning my time, I observed ShinyHunters having gone quiet since the massive haul that would have been the Instructure ransom. It was two weeks almost to the hour since I'd first heard rumour of payment being made,

19. Some notes on how we ended up with Palantir & how to replace it

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Sat, 23 May 2026 10:30:00 +0200

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/some-notes-on-palantir/>

There is justified anger about governments relying on Palantir software. There are also calls to write replacement software, perhaps imbued with European values, and with less fascism. And I'd love for that to happen pronto, but first we need to understand a few things. It is not just the software. Image by Mariia Shalabaieva on Unsplash ? Palantir is often called a data broker, a data miner, or a giant database of personal information.

20. Antibodies on command?

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Fri, 27 Mar 2020 17:56:22 +0100

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/antibodies/>

(On this page in Dutch I post daily bits of realistic but hopeful Corona news. Here is a

somehat rough translation of an article on antibodies I posted there, because I think it might also be useful for people that don't speak Dutch). Friday March 27: antibodies on demand? Those who have read the previous posts will recall that antibodies from people who have already been cured can help us to be vaccinated temporarily, or even heal us faster from disease.

21. Corona/COVID-19 Selftest Warning

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Sat, 21 Mar 2020 14:12:11 +0100

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/corona-selftest-warning/>

Several sites are now shipping 'COVID-19 self test kits' or perhaps 'Coronavirus self test kits'. These claim to detect the virus in 10 minutes based on a drop of blood. These rapid self-test kits are currently: Likely fake Even if not fake, they do NOT test for the virus, they do NOT do what you think they do Even if they do what they are supposed to, these tests have not been validated and could be wrong a lot.